

2024

03

February

Saturday

PRIOR

09.00 • But how do we know that the uniformity assumption is true? Can we perhaps prove its truth somehow? No, says Hume, we cannot. For it is easy to imagine a world where nature is not uniform but changes its course randomly from day to day. In such a world, computers might sometimes explode for no reason, water might somewhat intoxicate us without warning, and billiard balls might sometimes stop dead on colliding.

10.00

11.00

12.00 Since such a non-uniform world is conceivable, it follows that we cannot prove that the uniformity assumption is true. For if we could, then the non-uniform universe would be a logical impossibility.

14.00 → My argument

1. I can conceive a non-uniform universe.
2. That act of conceiving must arise from brain processes.
3. Brain processes presumably operate according to laws. ??
4. But to trust those laws tomorrow, I must assume: 1) the brain will function the same way 2) cognition will remain stable.
5. That assumption itself relies on uniformity.

18.00 Therefore: I am using uniformity of mental processes to justify uniformity of nature.

19.00 Which means: Uniformity is presupposed even in doubting uniformity.

04 Sunday → Circularity.

• Even if we cannot prove the uniformity assumption, we might nonetheless hope to find good empirical evidence for its truth. After all, the assumption has always held good up to now, so surely this is

January 2024							February 2024						
Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa	Su	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa	Su
01	2	3	4	5	6	7	05			1	2	3	4
02	8	9	10	11	12	13	06	5	6	7	8	9	10
03	15	16	17	18	19	20	07	12	13	14	15	16	17
04	22	23	24	25	26	27	08	19	20	21	22	23	24
05	29	30	31				09	26	27	28	29		